MADHAN IRULANDI

Senior Release Train Engineer & Technical Program Manager | SAFe® 6 SM & POPM | Microsoft Certified Trainer

Chennai, India (open to relocation worldwide) • irulandi.madhan@gmail.com • LinkedIn • madhanirulandi.com

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Delivery leader with 13 years across retail, insurance and healthcare for clients including Walmart, MetLife, Manulife, Allstate, Anthem and John Hancock, on systems serving 20M+ insurance policyholders. Govern releases for 30+ teams and 200+ people and turn around at-risk programs. Microsoft Certified Trainer since 2020: 3,000+ people trained, 75+ guest lectures.

- **Turnaround.** Restarted a multi-million-dollar John Hancock platform stalled two years by COVID, clearing 400+ backlog tickets in 9 months and taking all 5 modernization initiatives live across 20+ business divisions.
- **Predictability.** Averaged 95%+ of planned work delivered per planning cycle since taking over the release train in Sep 2025, with under 5% sprint variance.
- **AI delivery.** Steered a hybrid AI and RAG compliance engine to production, lowering false alarms in customer onboarding from 30% to 10–15%.
- **Teaching.** 3,000+ people trained since 2020, 75+ guest lectures and 1,000+ professionals mentored.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Release & Program Leadership: Release Train Engineering, PI Planning, ART Sync, Scrum-of-Scrums, SAFe® 6, Program & Portfolio Governance, Release Management, executive status reporting

Scrum & Agile Facilitation: Sprint Planning, Backlog Refinement, Retrospectives, Kanban, Agile coaching, mentoring Scrum Masters, onshore/offshore teams

Delivery Management: Budget ownership across multiple programs, Risk & Dependency Management, RAID logs, change management, Function Point capacity planning, DevOps & CI/CD

Technology: Generative AI & RAG, Azure AI, AKS, Apigee (JWT, OAuth 2.0), GitLab, Jenkins, OpenText xPression & Exstream, SS&C Chorus BPM (AWD)

Mainframe: z/OS, COBOL, JCL, DB2, CICS, VSAM, CA-7

Tools: Jira, Confluence, Azure DevOps, ServiceNow, MS Project, Power BI, Tableau, SQL, Miro, Visio

Domains: Insurance, Financial Services, Healthcare, Retail

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ATOS — Chennai, India & Boston, USA — **Sep 2020 – Present**

Senior Release Train Engineer / Program Manager — **Sep 2025 – Present | Chennai (Hybrid)**

Client: **Global insurer** · *Core API, Customer Engagement & Compliance AI*

- Steered a hybrid AI and RAG compliance engine to production, lowering false alarms in customer onboarding from 30% to 10–15%.
- Averaged 95%+ of planned work delivered each planning cycle (ART predictability) through disciplined PI planning.
- Maintain a High health rating across the products, with under 5% sprint variance.
- Reduced technical debt and strengthened platform security, moving 15 core services to AKS and 7 microservices to Gradle.
- Govern releases for 30+ teams and 200+ people across a global insurer's portfolio, leading the cross-team call on dependencies, risks and go/no-go decisions.
- Coach Scrum Masters across the train through end-of-sprint check-ins and regular sessions on SAFe updates.

Technical Product Manager / Release Train Engineer — **Sep 2022 – Aug 2025 | Boston, USA (On-site)**

Client: **John Hancock** · *AWD to SS&C Chorus BPM modernization*

- Restarted a multi-million-dollar platform program stalled for two years by COVID, rebuilding the release process and clearing 400+ backlog tickets in 9 months.
- Brought effort estimates to within 10% of actual work in the first quarter by introducing structured capacity planning (Function Point analysis), trimming overtime and idle time.
- Ran a portfolio of 5 modernization initiatives across 20+ business divisions, taking every one live through coordinated upgrades.
- Delivered the AWD workflow platform's first upgrades since its 2019 release, finishing most of the work by Q2 2023, within a year of taking over.
- Migrated all teams off AWD's legacy EnCorr and Viewstation desktops onto SS&C Chorus BPM, its current generation, before handing over in Aug 2025.

Senior Scrum Master / Agile Project Manager — **Sep 2020 – Aug 2022 | Chennai (Hybrid)**

Client: **Allstate** · *Customer communications platform*

- Accelerated production deployments from monthly to near-weekly by clearing blockers as the main escalation point between engineering and client executives, reaching 20M+ Allstate and 400K Encompass policyholders.
- Cut program cost 25% by streamlining the SDLC, without hiring, and raised team velocity 30% through hands-on Agile coaching.

SYNTEL (acquired by Atos) — Scrum Master / Agile Delivery Lead — **Jan 2020 – Aug 2020 | Chennai**

Client: **TruStage (formerly CUNA Mutual Group)** · *xPression document project*

- Stood up a new team and ramped it to full speed within two months, completing half of the work with a third of the existing vendor's headcount.
- Shipped every production release defect-free by building a layered automated test framework for regression, smoke and schema checks.

COGNIZANT — Chennai, India — **Jul 2014 – Jan 2020**

Technology Lead / Senior Analyst (2017–2020) • Systems Engineer / Application Analyst (2015–2017) • Production Support Engineer (2014–2015)

- **MetLife:** Spearheaded the move from a legacy publisher to OpenText xPression, migrating 4,500+ policy documents with zero defects and freeing up 2,000 engineering hours a quarter (Certificate of Excellence, May 2019).
- **Anthem (now Elevance Health):** Consolidated legacy layouts into dynamic master templates with OpenText Exstream and xPression, saving $300K a year in operating costs.
- **Walmart:** Resolved 50+ critical P1/P2 outages and 120 high-priority incidents through peak retail periods on the mainframe Order Management System (z/OS, COBOL, JCL, DB2, CICS, VSAM, CA-7).

DELL TECHNOLOGIES — Senior Customer Care Representative — **Aug 2013 – May 2014 | Chennai**

- Headed a 15-member team as acting Operations Project Lead, recovering more than $150K a quarter by settling high-value payment discrepancies.

EARLY CAREER — Wizcraft & Encompass Event Group (freelance, part-time) — **2009 – 2013**

- Part-time freelance work: ran a 40-strong VIP hospitality crew at Chepauk during the IPL and drove Chennai promotions for India's first Formula 1 Grand Prix (2011), before moving into IT in 2013.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified SAFe® 6 Scrum Master • Certified SAFe® 6 Product Owner / Product Manager • Microsoft Certified Trainer
- Microsoft Azure AI Engineer Associate • Microsoft Azure Administrator Associate • GitLab Certified CI/CD Associate
- GitLab Certified Git Associate • Certified Jenkins Engineer • PagerDuty Incident Management • 80+ in total

EDUCATION

Master of Science, Computer Science (AI & ML) — **Woolf University** — **Aug 2026 – Mar 2028 (in progress)**

Bachelor of Engineering, Electrical & Electronics — **VELS University**, First Class — **2009 – 2013**

TRAINING, RECOGNITION & COMMUNITY

- **Training:** Microsoft Certified Trainer every year since 2020, teaching SAFe® practice (SM & POPM; not official Scaled Agile courses), Scrum & Kanban, Azure AI-102, AZ-104, AZ-900/AI-900/DP-900 and AWS & Google Cloud fundamentals to corporate teams, graduates and colleges.
- **Client feedback:** “Overall, your professionalism, organizational skills, and commitment to agile excellence make a real difference to our delivery and team confidence.” (Client Project Manager, insurance client).
- **Awards:** Eviden Spot Award, Scrum Master / Release Manager (Apr 2024); Star Volunteer, Atos Prayas Foundation (Mar 2023); Atos Spot Recognition for Interviewing and for Cloud Training (Feb 2022); Certificate of Excellence, MetLife & Cognizant (May 2019).
- **Speaking:** 75+ guest lectures, including Azure AI at VIT Chennai and Jeppiaar Engineering College, a cloud workshop for 215 Atos graduates, and CSR cloud training with NIIT Foundation and EduBridge India.
- **Code for Boston:** Volunteer member on the non-technical side (Sep 2022 – Aug 2025), helping newcomers get set up on MAPLE, Urban League Heat Pump Accelerator, National Police Data Coalition and HEAT.